

RELIGION WITHOUT GOD

DEFINITION AND POSSIBILITY TEST → FOUR NEGATIVE POSITIONS → BUDDHISM → JAINISM, MĪMĀMSĀ AND SĀMKHYA → CĀRVĀKA AS LIMIT CASE → NIETZSCHE AND POST-THEISM

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g11 repaired in place; prior artifacts unchanged outside the scoped current generation

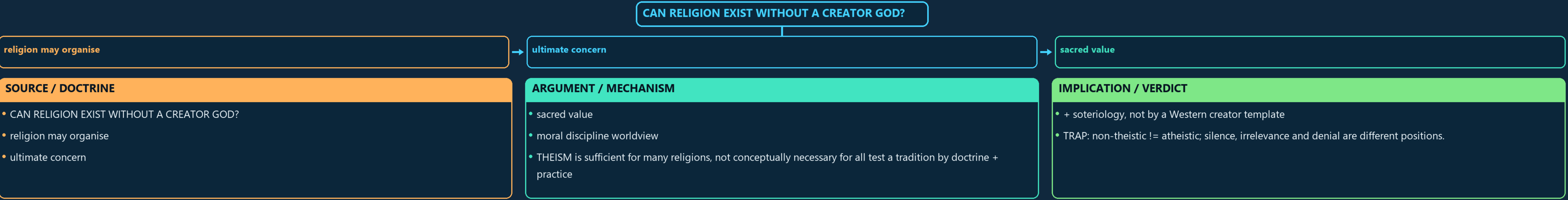
CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 DEFINITION AND POSSIBILITY TEST

DEFINITION AND POSSIBILITY TEST CAN RELIGION EXIST WITHOUT A CREATOR GOD? RELIGION MAY ORGANISE ULTIMATE CONCERN SACRED VALUE MORAL DISCIPLINE WORLDVIEW THEISM IS SUFFICIENT FOR MANY RELIGIONS, NOT CONCEPTUALLY NECESSARY

ATHEISTIC; SILENCE, IRRELEVANCE AND DENIAL ARE DIFFERENT POSITIONS.



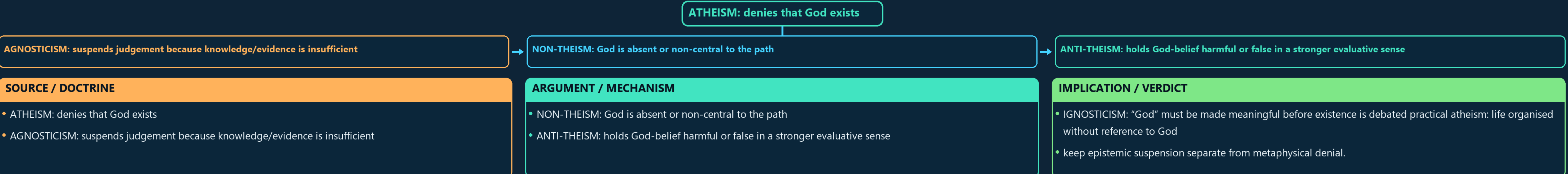
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Non-theistic religion is not identical with atheism: absence, irrelevance, denial and suspension of God-belief are distinct positions.

01

STAGE 01 FOUR NEGATIVE POSITIONS

FOUR NEGATIVE POSITIONS DENIES THAT GOD EXISTS SUSPENDS JUDGEMENT BECAUSE KNOWLEDGE/EVIDENCE IS INSUFFICIENT GOD IS ABSENT OR NON-CENTRAL TO THE PATH HOLDS GOD-BELIEF HARMFUL OR FALSE IN A STRONGER EVALUATIVE

"GOD" MUST BE MADE MEANINGFUL BEFORE EXISTENCE IS DEBATED LIFE ORGANISED WITHOUT REFERENCE TO GOD KEEP EPISTEMIC SUSPENSION



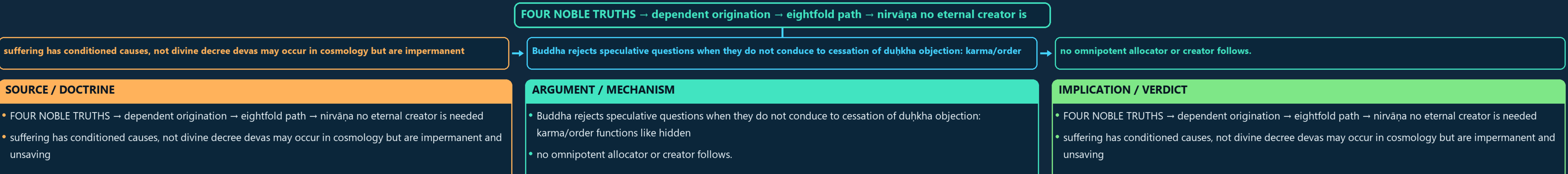
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Agnosticism suspends judgement about God's existence or knowability; unlike atheism, it withholds assent rather than asserting denial.

02

STAGE 02 BUDDHISM

FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS DEPENDENT ORIGINATION EIGHTFOLD PATH NIRVĀNA NO ETERNAL CREATOR IS NEEDED; SUFFERING HAS CONDITIONED BUDDHA REJECTS SPECULATIVE QUESTIONS WHEN THEY DO NOT CONDUCE KARMA/ORDER FUNCTIONS LIKE HIDDEN PROVIDENCE REPLY

CAUSAL-MORAL REGULARITY IS IMPERSONAL; NO OMNIPOTENT ALLOCATOR OR CREATOR



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dependent origination and karma (action and moral causation) make a creator explanatorily unnecessary, while ethics, meditation, community and nirvāna (liberation from suffering) preserve a fully religious form of life.

03

STAGE 03 JAINISM, MĪMĀMSĀ AND SĀMKHYA

JAINISM, MĪMĀMSĀ AND SĀMKHYA ETERNAL JĪVA/AJĪVA; KARMIC MATTER; TĪRTHĀṆKARA TEACHES, NOT CREATES AUTHORLESS ETERNAL VEDA; RITUAL ACTION GENERATES APŪRVA; NO DIVINE PRAKṚTI EVOLVES FOR PLURAL PURUṢAS; UNCONSCIOUS TELEOLOGY WITHOUT CREATOR

IF GOD IS PERFECT, WHY CREATE? IF EMBODIED, WHO JAINISM RETAINS WORSHIPFUL EXEMPLARS; MĪMĀMSĀ CENTRES DHARMA/RITUAL SĀMKHYA CENTRES DISCRIMINATIVE METAPHYSICS AND KAIVALYA.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
JAINISM: eternal jīva/ajīva; karmic matter; tīrthāṅkara teaches, not creates	unconscious teleology without creator shared anti-creator pressure: if God is perfect, why create?	Sāmkhya centres discriminative metaphysics and kaivalya.
MĪMĀMSĀ: authorless eternal Veda; ritual action generates apūrva; no divine author needed	if embodied, who made body?	
SĀMKHYA: prakṛti evolves for plural puruṣas	distinctions: Jainism retains worshipful exemplars; Mīmāṃsā centres dharma/ritual	
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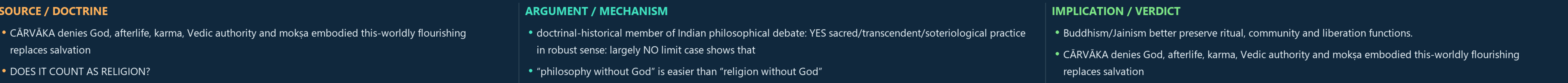
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism, Mīmāṃsā (ritual-exegesis school) and Sāmkhya (enumeration-based dualist school) show that liberation, scripture, ritual and cosmic explanation can be organised without a creator deity.

04

STAGE 04 CĀRVĀKA AS LIMIT CASE

CĀRVĀKA AS LIMIT CASE CĀRVĀKA DENIES GOD, AFTERLIFE, KARMA, VEDIC AUTHORITY AND MOKṢA DOES IT COUNT AS RELIGION? DOCTRINAL-HISTORICAL MEMBER OF INDIAN PHILOSOPHICAL DEBATE YES SACRED/TRANSCENDENT/SOTERIOLOGICAL PRACTICE IN ROBUST SENSE

LARGELY NO LIMIT CASE SHOWS THAT "PHILOSOPHY WITHOUT GOD" BUDDHISM/JAINISM BETTER PRESERVE RITUAL, COMMUNITY AND LIBERATION FUNCTIONS.



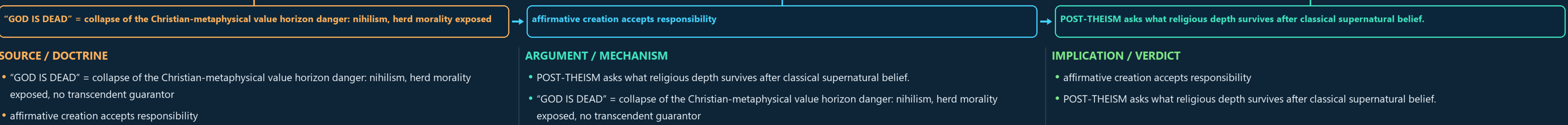
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Non-theistic traditions replace different divine functions separately—creation, authority, moral causation, worship or salvation—so 'religion without God' names several arguments rather than one model.

05

STAGE 05 NIETZSCHE AND POST-THEISM

NIETZSCHE AND POST-THEISM "GOD IS DEAD" COLLAPSE OF THE CHRISTIAN-METAPHYSICAL VALUE HORIZON DANGER NIHILISM, HERD MORALITY EXPOSED, NO TRANSCENDENT GUARANTOR TASK REVALUATION OF VALUES LIFE-AFFIRMATION NOT A SIMPLE EMPIRICAL PROOF THAT NO DEITY

SELF-CREATED VALUES RISK ARBITRARINESS OR DOMINATION REPLY GENEALOGY TESTS INHERITED VALUES; AFFIRMATIVE CREATION ACCEPTS RESPONSIBILITY



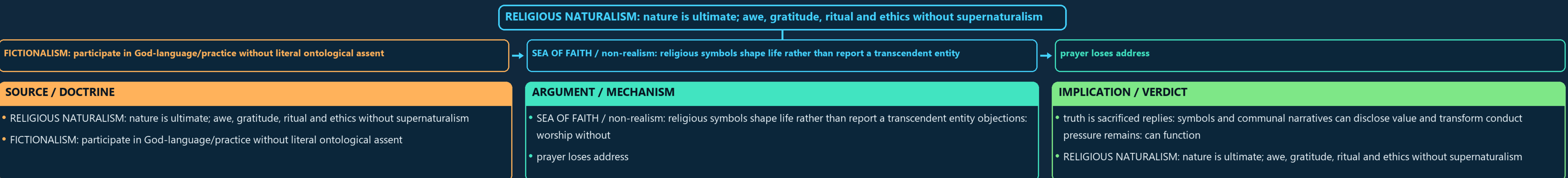
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nietzsche's 'death of God' is a diagnosis of the collapse of a value-horizon, not merely a proof of atheism; its unresolved task is the non-arbitrary revaluation of values.

06

STAGE 06 NATURALISM AND FICTIONALISM

NATURALISM AND FICTIONALISM RELIGIOUS NATURALISM NATURE IS ULTIMATE; AWE, GRATITUDE, RITUAL AND ETHICS WITHOUT PARTICIPATE IN GOD-LANGUAGE/PRACTICE WITHOUT LITERAL ONTOLOGICAL ASSENT SEA OF FAITH RELIGIOUS SYMBOLS SHAPE LIFE RATHER THAN REPORT A TRANSCENDENT

WORSHIP WITHOUT REAL OBJECT IS MAKE-BELIEVE; PRAYER LOSES ADDRESS SYMBOLS AND COMMUNAL NARRATIVES CAN DISCLOSE VALUE AND TRANSFORM



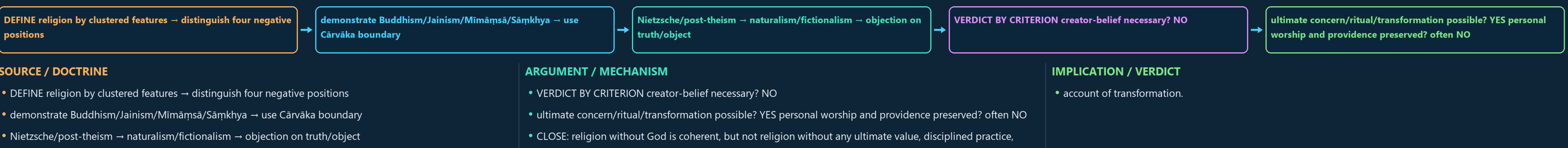
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religious naturalism retains ultimacy within nature, whereas religious fictionalism retains participation without literal assent; the decisive test is whether either preserves sincere transformation rather than mere aesthetics.

07

STAGE 07 PYQ AND QUALIFIED VERDICT

PYQ AND QUALIFIED VERDICT DEFINE RELIGION BY CLUSTERED FEATURES DISTINGUISH FOUR NEGATIVE POSITIONS DEMONSTRATE BUDDHISM/JAINISM/MĪMĀMSĀ/SĀMKHYA USE CĀRVĀKA BOUNDARY OBJECTION ON TRUTH/OBJECT VERDICT BY CRITERION CREATOR-BELIEF NECESSARY? NO

ULTIMATE CONCERN/RITUAL/TRANSFORMATION POSSIBLE? YES PERSONAL WORSHIP AND PROVIDENCE PRESERVED?



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion without God is conceptually possible where ultimate concern, discipline and transformation survive, though personal providence and theistic worship do not.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] DOCTRINE STATEMENT. SUBSTANTIVE DEFINITIONS IDENTIFY RELIGION BY REFERENCE TO GODS OR FUNCTIONAL DEFINITIONS IDENTIFY ORIENTATION, PRACTICE, COMMUNITY, MEANING OR LIBERATION.

IF CREATOR-BELIEF IS MADE NECESSARY BY DEFINITION, BUDDHISM IS A MULTIDIMENSIONAL ACCOUNT BETTER CAPTURES DOCTRINE, RITUAL, ETHICS, EXPERIENCE PRESUPPOSITION. CAUTION

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS	ADVANCED OBJECTION	COMPARATIVE NUANCE
Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]	Argument.	Distinction. Non-theistic differs from atheistic: absence of a creator doctrine does not require denial of every deity or sacred being.
Doctrine statement.	CAUTION: If creator-belief is made necessary by definition, Buddhism is excluded by stipulation	Canonical example. Theravāda Buddhism permits cosmological devas yet denies their creatorhood and salvific ultimacy.
Substantive definitions identify religion by reference to gods or the sacred	a multidimensional account better captures doctrine, ritual, ethics, experience, narrative and institution.	Objection → reply.
functional definitions identify orientation, practice, community, meaning or liberation.	Presupposition: CAUTION: "Religion" names a family of historically varied practices rather than one essence.	CAUTION: Functional definitions may classify nationalism as religion.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.